

Aden Thompson

Technical Artist

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Objective

Computer Science student and Technical Artist with a fine arts background and experience optimizing cross-platform shaders, building custom editor utilities and pipeline tools, and designing realtime VFX in Unreal Engine. Specializing in shaders/VFX, DCC scripting, pipeline tooling. Seeking roles where I can solve complex technical challenges, eliminate bottlenecks, and empower creative teams.

Education

B.S. in Computer Science, *University of Central Florida*
Technical Art Mentorship, *Hard Edge Games Training School*

Expected Aug 2027
Jan 2026 – Dec 2026

Technical Skills

Code: Python, C++, C#, HLSL, Java

Tools: Unreal Engine 5, Unity, Git, Perforce, Maya, Substance Painter & Designer, Photoshop, RenderDoc, Unreal Insights

Skills: Blueprints, Materials/Shaders, Niagara, Editor Utilities, Pipeline Tools, DCC Scripting, Profiling/Optimization, VR/AR development

Professional Experience

Technical Art Intern, *Limbitless Solutions, Orlando, FL*

May 2026 – Present

- Engineer therapeutic video games for children with bionic limbs in Unreal Engine 5 for PC, Android, and iOS
- Diagnose and resolve cross-platform shader compilation issues, reducing visual artifacts for mobile devices
- Design real-time gameplay VFX using Niagara systems and custom Scratch Pad modules
- Build stylized materials using Substance Designer and Photoshop mask workflows
- Prototype gameplay mechanics alongside engineers using Blueprints and C++

XR Research Intern, *UCF Synthetic Reality Lab (SREAL), Orlando, FL*

Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Developed interactive XR simulations for Meta Quest and XREAL hardware using Unity for the Office of Naval Research
- Engineered a mixed-reality interactive map using Cesium and Google Maps API to stream live geospatial data
- Implemented 6DOF spatial tracking, spatial anchors, and image tracking to ground virtual objects in physical space
- Used Photon PUN 2 to network devices, enabling real-time synchronized updates to the shared virtual map across users

Projects

USD Asset Thumbnail/Card Generator – *ASWF Dev Days 2026, Digital Production Example Library (DPEL)*

Sep 2026 – Present

- Built a Python script that generates thumbnails and cards for USD assets by iterating over leaf model/component prims, framing and rendering each, and updating USD metadata

Jalopy Jetsream – *GDK Space Jam*

Sep 2025

- Modeled and textured 5 space debris props using Maya and Substance Painter
- Authored a tiling space texture in Substance Designer to serve as a scrolling background

It IS Rocket Science! – *Multiplayer Co-op Game*

Jan 2025 – June 2025

- Migrated UI systems from TextMeshPro to Unity UI Toolkit in C#, rebuilding the main menu, lobby, pause menu, and HUD
- Modeled and textured 15+ low/mid-poly assets using Maya and Substance Painter
- Designed UI elements using Figma and Adobe Illustrator, including buttons, modals, and menu screens

Leadership

President, *UCF Game Development Club (GameDev Knights)*

May 2026 – Present

- Lead a team of 6 officers and oversee a student organization with 480 members focused on uplifting aspiring game developers
- Coordinate 5 workshops, 2 game jams (40 participants each), and an industry panel with 7 professionals and ~100 attendees
- Launch Project Forge, connecting 86 students into 16 teams to build games together over the course of a semester
- Direct a mentorship program connecting 33 students with 14 industry professionals and alumni mentors

Interests

Favorite games: The Sims 3, Prison Architect, Breath of the Wild | **Hobbies:** Gaming, Drawing, Journaling